

FIELD NOTE

**Your company has
a GitHub for code.**

**It has nothing for
what it knows.**

And AI has just made that gap expensive.

TWO QUESTIONS

Ask a software team where their code lives.
You get a one-word answer.

Ask a marketing team where their knowledge lives. You get a pause, then a list. Some of it's in the research folder. Some's in decks. Some's in a doc from the launch. Quite a lot is in Sarah's head.

Sarah left in March.

WHERE YOUR KNOWLEDGE ACTUALLY LIVES

~ assets the organisation paid for

- **customer research** → a PDF in an email thread
- **interview transcripts** → never kept
- **the campaign argument** → a deck, minus the reasoning
- **tone, claims, positions** → two people's heads
- **refined AI prompts** → personal chat histories

Every one of these is an asset you paid for.
Almost none is in a state you could find,
trust, build on, or hand to an AI system.

THE CONDITION MOST COMPANIES ARE IN

Rich in knowledge. Bankrupt in memory.

Compounding isn't a mindset. It needs
somewhere to physically happen.

One source of truth

Not “final_v3_FINAL_amended”. Disagreement resolved by review.

History survives

What changed, when, and — because every change carries a message — why.

Change is reviewed

Improvement is a process, not an accident of whoever last opened the file.

Everything is connected

A system where you can trace what depends on what.

1

Structuring the knowledge improved the knowledge.

Writing a workflow down exposes the steps you were skipping. Versioning a framework shows you where you contradict last month.

2

AI became dramatically more useful.

The models never changed. I could finally hand them something worth working with.

The difference isn't the AI. It's what the AI has to stand on.

Pick the most expensive knowledge your organisation produced last year. Could a new joiner:

- ☐ **Find it?**
- ☐ **Understand why it says what it says?**
- ☐ **See what's been built on it since?**
- ☐ **Hand it to an AI in a usable form?**

IF THE ANSWER IS NO

The knowledge isn't an asset yet. It's an anecdote with a budget line.

Engineers stopped accepting that trade a generation ago. The tools have finally made the same refusal affordable for everyone else.